“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 5

The Description of the Deeds of Sākṣi-gopāla

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the «Anubhāṣya», 2026 — draft)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. Mahāprabhu passed through Yājapura and reached the city of Kaṭaka. There He went for *darśana* of Śrī Sākṣi-gopāla and heard from the mouth of Nityānanda Prabhu the story of Gopāla. Two brāhmaṇas of Vidyānagara (one old, the other young) had visited many holy places and come to Śrī Vṛndāvana. The old brāhmaṇa, pleased with the young one's service, promised to give him his daughter in marriage. The young brāhmaṇa had the old one repeat this promise before the Gopāla who resides in Vṛndāvana, and made Gopāla the witness. When they returned home and the young brāhmaṇa proposed the marriage, the old one, giving in to the urging of his son, wife and other relatives, said, “I do not remember my promise.” The young brāhmaṇa then went back to Gopāla, told Him everything, won His consent by his devotion, and brought Him to the southern country. Gopāla walked behind the young brāhmaṇa, sounding His ankle bells, came as far as the outskirts of Vidyānagara, and stopped there. The young brāhmaṇa gathered there the respectable people of the region, together with the old brāhmaṇa and his son, and had Gopāla give His testimony. Astonished, they arranged the marriage of the young brāhmaṇa to the old one's daughter. The king of that country, filled with devotion for Gopāla, built Him a temple and so on. Long afterward the king of Vidyānagara scornfully called Puruṣottama-deva, the lord of Utkala, “Jagannātha's sweeper” and refused to give him his daughter. Puruṣottama-deva then won the help of Śrī Jagannātha, made war on that king, defeated him, and took both his daughter and his kingdom. From that time Gopāla, bound by the rope of devotion of the Vaiṣṇava king Puruṣottama-deva, was brought to the city of Kaṭaka. Having

heard this story, Mahāprabhu had *darśana* of Gopāla with great love. From Kaṭaka He came to Bhuvaneśvara for *darśana* of Śiva, and at Kamalapura, on the bank of the Bhārgī River, on the pretext of seeing Śiva as Kapoteśvara He left His staff in Nityānanda's hands and went away. Nityānanda broke the staff into three pieces and set it floating on the Bhārgī. When Mahāprabhu reached "Āṭhāranālā" and did not get His staff back, He left His companions behind and went on to the Śrī Mandira.

Obeisance to Sākṣi-gopāla, who submits to His devotee —

পদ্ভ্যাং চলন্ যঃ প্রতিমা-স্বরূপো
ব্রহ্মণ্যদেবো হি শতাহগম্যম্ ।
দেশং যযৌ বিপ্রকৃতেঽদ্ভুতেঽহং
তং সাক্ষিগোপালমহং নতোঽস্মি ॥ ১ ॥

padbhyāṁ calan yaḥ pratimā-svarūpo
on His feet walking who in the form of the Deity
brahmaṇya-devo hi śatāha-gamyam
the Lord of the brāhmaṇas indeed a hundred days' journey away
deśaṁ yayau vipra-kṛte 'dbhute 'haṁ
to the land went for a brāhmaṇa's sake of wondrous deeds
taṁ sākṣi-gopālam ahaṁ nato 'smi
to that Sākṣi-gopāla I bowed down am

1 I bow down to Sākṣi-gopāla, the Lord of the brāhmaṇas, wondrous in His deeds. For a brāhmaṇa's sake He walked on His own feet, in His form as the Deity, to a land a hundred days' journey away.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
That Brahmaṇya-deva who, while in the form of a Deity (*pratimā*), walked on His own feet for the good of a brāhmaṇa to a land a hundred days' journey away — to that Sākṣi-gopāla of wondrous deeds I bow down.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ (Gopāla), **pratimā-svarūpaḥ** (the form manifest as the *arcā*, the Deity) **brahmaṇya-devaḥ**, **padbhyāṁ calan vipra-kṛte** (for the good of a brāhmaṇa) **hi śatāha-gamyam** (reached in a hundred days) **deśam** (from Māthura-maṇḍala to

Vidyānagara) **yayau**, **ahaṁ tam adbhutehaṁ** (of unprecedented deeds)[7] **sākṣi-gopālam nataḥ asmi** (I bow down).

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaitacandra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

*At Yājapura the Lord has *darśana* of Varāha-deva —*

চলিতে চলিতে আইলা যাজপুর গ্রাম ।
বরাহ-ঠাকুর দেখি' করিলা প্রণাম ॥ ৩ ॥

calite calite āilā yājapura grāma
walking walking came Yājapura village
varāha-ṭhākura dekhi' karilā praṇāma
the Deity Varāha seeing made obeisance

3 Walking on and on, the Lord came to the village of Yājapura, and there He saw the Deity of Varāha and bowed down to Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Yājapura is a special holy place in the land of Utkala, on the bank of the Vaitaraṇī River, in Virajā-kṣetra; it is "Nābhi-gayā."

Anubhāṣya.

Yājapura is one of the subdivisions of Kaṭaka district. It is called "Nābhi-gayā." Varāha-deva resides here, in the quarter called "Brāhmaṇanagara."

The Lord dances, sings, and spends the night there —

নৃত্যগীত কৈল প্রেমে বহুত স্তবন ।
যাজপুরে সে রাত্রি রহি' করিলা গমন ॥ ৪ ॥

nṛtya-gīta kaila preme bahuta stavana
dancing and singing did in love many prayers
yājapure se rātri rahi' karilā gamana
in Yājapura that night staying made departure

4 Full of love, He danced and sang and offered many prayers. He stayed that night in Yājapura and then went on His way.[2]

**Darśana* of Sākṣi-gopāla at Kaṭaka —*

কটকে আইলা সাক্ষিগোপাল দেখিতে ।
গোপাল-সৌন্দর্য্য দেখি' হৈলা আনন্দিতে ॥ ৫ ॥

kaṭake āilā sākṣi-gopāla dekhite
to Kaṭaka came Sākṣi-gopāla to see
gopāla-saundarya dekhi' hailā ānandite
Gopāla's beauty seeing became joyful

5 He came to Kaṭaka to see Sākṣi-gopāla, and the sight of Gopāla's beauty filled Him with joy.

Absorbed in love, the Lord dances and sings —

প্রেমাবেশে নৃত্যগীত কৈল কতক্ষণ ।
আবিষ্ট হঞা কৈল গোপাল স্তবন ॥ ৬ ॥

premāveśe nṛtya-gīta kaila kata-kṣaṇa
absorbed in love dancing and singing did for some time
āviṣṭa hañā kaila gopāla stavana
absorbed being made to Gopāla prayers

6 Absorbed in love, He danced and sang for some time, and in that rapture He offered prayers to Gopāla.

Spending that night in the temple, the Lord hears from Nityānanda's mouth the story of Sākṣi-gopāla —

সেই রাত্রি তাঁহা রহি' ভক্তগণ-সঙ্গে ।
গোপালের পূর্ব্বকথা শুনে প্রভু রঙ্গে ॥ ৭ ॥

sei rātri tāṁhā rahi' bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge
that night there staying with the devotees
gopālera pūrva-kathā śune prabhu raṅge
of Gopāla the old story hears the Lord with delight

7 He stayed there that night with His devotees, and with delight the Lord heard the old story of Gopāla.

Nitāi earlier had the chance to hear it while traveling to the holy places —

নিত্যানন্দ-গোসাঞি যবে তীর্থ ভ্রমিলা ।
সাক্ষিগোপাল দেখিবারে কটক আইলা ॥ ৮ ॥

nityānanda-gosāñi yabe tīrtha bhramilā
Nityānanda Gosāñi when holy places travelled
sākṣi-gopāla dekhibāre kaṭaka āilā
Sākṣi-gopāla to see to Kaṭaka came

8 Long before, when Nityānanda Gosāñi was travelling to the holy places, He had come to Kaṭaka to see Sākṣi-gopāla.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Sākṣi-gopāla. Kaṭaka is the chief city on the bank of the Mahānadī, and at that time Sākṣi-gopāla resided there. When Sākṣi-gopāla was brought from the southern country, He first stayed in Kaṭaka for some days, and then for some time in the temple of Śrī Jagannātha at Śrī Puruṣottama. There a kind of loving quarrel (*prema-kalaha*) arose, and so the Mahārāja, the lord of Utkala, founded a village called "Satyavādī" three *krośas* from Puruṣottama and kept Gopāla there. Now Śrī Sākṣi-gopāla resides in that village, in a solidly built temple.

সাক্ষিগোপালের কথা শুনি' লোকমুখে ।
সেই কথা কহেন, প্রভু শুনে মহাসুখে ॥ ৯ ॥

sākṣi-gopālera kathā śuni' loka-mukhe
of Sākṣi-gopāla the story hearing from people's lips
sei kathā kahena, prabhu śune mahā-sukhe
that story He tells the Lord hears with great happiness

9 He had heard the story of Sākṣi-gopāla from the people there. Now He told it, and the Lord listened with great happiness.

The story of Sākṣi-gopāla; the account of the two brāhmaṇas —

পূর্ব্বে বিদ্যানগরের দুই ত' ব্রাহ্মণ ।
তীর্থ করিবারে দুঁহে করিলা গমন ॥ ১০ ॥

pūrve vidyānagarera dui ta' brāhmaṇa
long ago of Vidyānagara two indeed brāhmaṇas
tīrtha karibāre duṁhe karilā gamana
pilgrimage to make both made departure

10 Long ago two brāhmaṇas of Vidyānagara set out together on pilgrimage.

গয়া, বারাণসী, প্রয়াগ — সকল করিয়া ।
মথুরাতে আইলা দুঁহে আনন্দিত হঞা ॥ ১১ ॥

gayā, vārāṇasī, prayāga — sakala kariyā
Gayā Vārāṇasī Prayāga all visiting
mathurāte āilā duṁhe ānandita hañā
to Mathurā came both joyful being

11 They visited Gayā, Vārāṇasī, Prayāga and all the holy places, and then the two of them came joyfully to Mathurā.

বনযাত্রায় বন দেখি' দেখে গোবর্দ্ধন ।
দ্বাদশ-বন দেখি' শেষে গেলা বৃন্দাবন ॥ ১২ ॥

vana-yātrāya vana dekhi' dekhe govardhana
on the forest pilgrimage the forests seeing they see Govardhana
dvādaśa-vana dekhi' śeṣe gelā vṛndāvana
the twelve forests seeing at last went to Vṛndāvana

12 On their pilgrimage through the forests of Vraja they wandered from forest to forest and saw Govardhana; and when they had visited all twelve forests, they came at last to Vṛndāvana.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The twelve forests. Bhadra, Bilva, Lauha, Bhāṇḍīra and Mahāvana — these five forests lie east of the Yamunā; Madhu, Tāla, Kumuda, Bahulā, Kāmya, Khadira and Vṛndāvana — these last seven forests lie west of the Yamunā. After seeing these twelve forests the brāhmaṇas finally went to the place called "Pañcakrośī Vṛndāvana." The meaning is this: the Vṛndāvana that is one of the twelve forests begins from this Vṛndāvana and extends sixteen *krośas* up to Nandagrāma and Varṣāṇa; within it lies the village called "Pañcakrośī Vṛndāvana."

বৃন্দাবনে গোবিন্দ-স্থানে মহাদেবালয় ।
সে মন্দিরে গোপালের মহা-সেবা হয় ॥ ১৩ ॥

vṛndāvane govinda-sthāne mahā-devālaya
in Vṛndāvana at Govinda's place a great temple
se mandire gopālera mahā-sevā haya
in that temple Gopāla's great service takes place

13 In Vṛndāvana, at the place of Govinda, there stood a great temple, and in that temple Gopāla was served with great splendour.

কেশীতীর্থ, কালীয়-হ্রদাদিকে কৈল স্নান ।
শ্রীগোপাল দেখি' তাঁহা করিলা বিশ্রাম ॥ ১৪ ॥

keśī-tīrtha, kālīya-hradādike kaila snāna
at Keśī-tīrtha at Kāliya-hrada and others did bathing
śrī-gopāla dekhi' tāṁhā karilā viśrāma
Śrī Gopāla seeing there made rest

14 They bathed at Keśī-tīrtha, Kāliya-hrada and the other holy places, and after seeing Śrī Gopāla they rested there.

গোপাল-সৌন্দর্য্য দুঁহার মন নিল হরি' ।
সুখ পাঞা রহে তাঁহা দিন দুই-চারি ॥ ১৫ ॥

gopāla-saundarya duṁhāra mana nila hari'
Gopāla's beauty of both the hearts took stealing
sukha pāñā rahe tāṁhā dina dui-cāri
happiness finding they stay there days two or four

15 Gopāla's beauty stole the hearts of both of them, and they stayed there happily for a few days.

দুইবিপ্র-মধ্যে এক বিপ্র — বৃদ্ধপ্রায় ।
আর বিপ্র — যুবা, তাঁর করেন সহায় ॥ ১৬ ॥

dui-vipra-madhye eka vipra — vṛddha-prāya
the two brāhmaṇas among one brāhmaṇa nearly old
āra vipra — yuvā, tāṁra karena sahāya
the other brāhmaṇa young him gives help

16 Of the two brāhmaṇas, one was elderly and the other young, and the younger looked after the elder.

ছোটবিপ্র করে সদা তাঁহার সেবন ।
তাঁহার সেবায় বিপ্রের তুষ্ট হৈল মন ॥ ১৭ ॥

choṭa-vipra kare sadā tāṁhāra sevana
the younger brāhmaṇa does always his service
tāṁhāra sevāya viprera tuṣṭa haila mana
by his service the brāhmaṇa's pleased became heart

17 The younger brāhmaṇa served him constantly, and the elder was pleased at heart with his service.

বিপ্র বলে, — তুমি মোর বহু সেবা কৈলা ।
সহায় হঞা মোরে তীর্থ করাইলা ॥ ১৮ ॥

vipra bale — tumi mora bahu sevā kailā
the brāhmaṇa says you me much service did
sahāya hañā more tīrtha karāilā
helper being me pilgrimage made to do

18 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “You have served me in so many ways. With your help I have been able to make this pilgrimage.

পুত্রেও পিতার ঐছে না করে সেবন ।
তোমার প্রসাদে আমি না পাইলাম শ্রম ॥ ১৯ ॥

putreo pitāra aiche nā kare sevana
even a son father’s such not does service
tomāra prasāde āmi nā pāilāma śrama
by your kindness I not felt fatigue

19 Even a son does not serve his father like this. By your kindness I have felt no fatigue.

কৃতঘ্নতা হয় তোমায় না কৈলে সম্মান ।
অতএব তোমায় আমি দিব কন্যাদান ॥ ২০ ॥

kṛta-ghnatā haya tomāya nā kaile sammāna
ingratitude it is you not if I do honour
ataeva tomāya āmi diba kanyā-dāna
therefore to you I shall give the gift of a daughter

20 It would be ingratitude not to honour you. So I shall give you my daughter in marriage.”

ছোটবিপ্র কহে, — শুন, বিপ্র-মহাশয় ।
অসম্ভব কহ কেনে, যেই নাহি হয় ॥ ২১ ॥

choṭa-vipra kahe, — śuna, vipra-mahāśaya
the younger brāhmaṇa says listen respected brāhmaṇa
asambhava kaha kene, yei nāhi haya
the impossible you speak why which not happens

21 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, respected sir! Why do you speak of something impossible, something that can never be?

মহাকুলীন তুমি — বিদ্যা-ধনাদি-প্রবীণ ।
আমি অকুলীন, আর ধন-বিদ্যা-হীন ॥ ২২ ॥

mahā-kulīna tumi — vidyā-dhanādi-pravīṇa
of very high family you in learning, wealth and all else rich
āmi akulīna, āra dhana-vidyā-hīna
I of no family and of wealth and learning devoid

22 You are of a very noble family and rich in learning, wealth and every other gift, while I am of no family and have neither wealth nor learning.

কন্যাদান-পাত্র আমি না হই তোমার ।
কৃষ্ণপ্রীত্যে করি তোমার সেবা-ব্যবহার ॥ ২৩ ॥

kanyā-dāna-pātra āmi nā hai tomāra
for the gift of a daughter a fit recipient I not am your
kṛṣṇa-prītye kari tomāra sevā-vyavahāra
for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure I do your service

23 I am not fit to receive your daughter. I serve you for Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure.

ব্রাহ্মণ-সেবায় কৃষ্ণের প্রীতি বড় হয় ।
তাঁহার সন্তোষে ভক্তি-সম্পদ্ বাড়য় ॥ ২৪ ॥

brāhmaṇa-sevāya kṛṣṇera prīti baḍa haya
by service to brāhmaṇas Kṛṣṇa’s pleasure great is
tāṁhāra santoṣe bhakti-sampad bāḍaya
by His satisfaction devotion’s wealth increases

24 Kṛṣṇa is greatly pleased by service to brāhmaṇas, and when He is pleased, the wealth of devotion grows.”

Anubhāṣya.

The younger brāhmaṇa served the elder brāhmaṇa, a devotee of Bhagavān, for Kṛṣṇa's pleasure, and it was as the fruit of this that Śrī Gopāla Ṭhākura gave His testimony, to protect the honor of His devotee. Had it been otherwise — had the younger brāhmaṇa's service to the elder, his obtaining consent to marry the elder's daughter, and the rest been worldly *karma-kāṇḍa* full of sense gratification — Śrīman Mahāprabhu and Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu would never have honored them.

বড়বিপ্র কহে, — তুমি না কর সংশয় ।
তোমাকে কন্যা দিব আমি, ইথে কি বিস্ময় ॥ ২৫ ॥

baḍa-vipra kahe, — tumi nā kara saṁśaya
the elder brāhmaṇa says you not do doubt
tomāke kanyā diba āmi, ithe ki vismaya
to you daughter shall give I in this what wonder

25 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “Have no doubt. I shall give you my daughter — what is so surprising in that?”[3]

ছোটবিপ্র বলে, — তোমার স্ত্রীপুত্র সব ।
বহু জ্ঞাতি-গোষ্ঠী তোমার বহুত বান্ধব ॥ ২৬ ॥

choṭa-vipra bale, — tomāra strī-putra saba
the younger brāhmaṇa says your wife and sons all
bahu jñāti-goṣṭhī tomāra bahuta bāndhava
many kinsmen and relatives your many friends

26 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “You have a wife and sons, many kinsmen and relatives, and a great many friends.

তা-সবার সম্মতি বিনা নহে কন্যাদান ।
রুক্মিণীর পিতা ভীষ্মক তাহাতে প্রমাণ ॥ ২৭ ॥

tā-sabāra sammati vinā nahe kanyā-dāna
of them all consent without is not the gift of a daughter
rukmiṇīra pitā bhīṣmaka tāhāte pramāṇa
Rukmiṇī’s father Bhīṣmaka of that proof

27 Without the consent of them all, a daughter cannot be given in marriage. Bhīṣmaka, the father of Rukmiṇī, is proof of this.

ভীষ্মকের ইচ্ছা, — কৃষ্ণে কন্যা সমর্পিতে ।
পুত্রের বিরোধে কন্যা নারিল অর্পিতে ॥” ॥ ২৮ ॥

bhīṣmakera icchā, — kṛṣṇe kanyā samarpite
Bhīṣmaka's wish to Kṛṣṇa daughter to offer
putrera virodhe kanyā nārila arpite”
of the son by the opposition daughter could not give

28 Bhīṣmaka wished to give his daughter to Kṛṣṇa, but his son opposed it, and he could not give her.”

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.52.21): “There was a great king named Bhīṣmaka, the ruler of Vidarbha. He had five sons and one daughter with a lovely face. … His kinsmen wanted to give [Rukmī's] sister to Kṛṣṇa, O king, but Rukmī, who hated Kṛṣṇa, stopped them and decided on Caidya.”[8] (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.53.2): “Śrī Bhagavān said: ‘In the same way I too, thinking of her, cannot sleep at night. I know that Rukmī, out of hatred, has prevented My marriage.’”

Rukmī, the eldest son of Bhīṣmaka, king of Vidarbha, insulted Kṛṣṇa when He was carrying off his sister Rukmiṇī, and fought with Him. He should have perished as a result, but at Rukmiṇī's request he kept his life: Kṛṣṇa cut off his beard and hair with His sword, shaved him, disfigured him, and let him go.

বড়বিপ্র কহে, — কন্যা মোর নিজ-ধন ।
নিজ-ধন দিতে নিষেধিবে কোন্ জন ॥ ২৯ ॥

baḍa-vipra kahe, — kanyā mora nija-dhana
the elder brāhmaṇa says daughter my own wealth
nija-dhana dite niṣedhibe kon jana
own wealth to give will forbid what person

29 The elder brāhmaṇa said, “My daughter is my own wealth. Who can forbid me to give away what is my own?

তোমাকে কন্যা দিব, সবাকে করি' তিরস্কার ।
সংশয় না কর তুমি, করহ স্বীকার ॥ ৩০ ॥

tomāke kanyā diba, sabāke kari' tiraskāra
to you daughter I shall give all making disregard
saṁśaya nā kara tumi, karaha svīkāra
doubt not do you do acceptance

30 I shall give you my daughter, and I shall pay no heed to any of them. Have no doubt; just accept her."

ছোটবিপ্র কহে, — যদি কন্যা দিতে মন ।
গোপালের আগে কহ এ সত্য-বচন ॥ ৩১ ॥

choṭa-vipra kahe, — "yadi kanyā dite mana
the younger brāhmaṇa says if daughter to give your mind
gopālera āge kaha e satya-vacana
Gopāla before say this true word

31 The younger brāhmaṇa said, "If you have truly made up your mind to give me your daughter, then say these true words before Gopāla."

গোপালের আগে বিপ্র কহিতে লাগিল ।
তুমি জান, নিজ-কন্যা ইহারে আমি দিল ॥ ৩২ ॥

gopālera āge vipra kahite lāgila
Gopāla before the brāhmaṇa to speak began
tumi jāna, nija-kanyā ihāre āmi dila
You know own daughter to him I gave

32 So before Gopāla the elder brāhmaṇa declared, "Know it, Lord: I have given my own daughter to him."

ছোটবিপ্র বলে, — ঠাকুর, তুমি মোর সাক্ষী ।
তোমা সাক্ষী বোলাইমু, যদি অন্যথা দেখি ॥ ৩৩ ॥

choṭa-vipra bale, — "ṭhākura, tumi mora sākṣī
the younger brāhmaṇa says Lord You my witness
tomā sākṣī bolāimu, yadi anyathā dekhi
You as witness I will call if otherwise I see

33 The younger brāhmaṇa said, "Lord, You are my witness. If I see him go back on his word, I will call on You to bear witness."

এত বলি' দুইজনে চলিলা দেশেরে ।
গুরুবুদ্ধ্যে ছোট-বিপ্র বহু সেবা করে ॥ ৩৪ ॥

eta bali' dui-jane calilā deśere
thus saying the two went homeward
guru-buddhye choṭa-vipra bahu sevā kare
regarding him as guru the younger brāhmaṇa much service does

34 With these words the two set out for home, and all along the way the younger brāhmaṇa served the elder devotedly, regarding him as his guru.

দেশে আসি' দুইজনে গেলা নিজ-ঘরে ।
কতদিনে বড়-বিপ্র চিন্তিত অন্তরে ॥ ৩৫ ॥

deśe āsi' dui-jane gelā nija-ghare
home coming the two went to their own houses
kata dine baḍa-vipra cintita antare
after some days the elder brāhmaṇa anxious at heart

35 When they reached their own country, each went to his own house. Some days later the elder brāhmaṇa grew anxious at heart:

তীর্থে বিপ্রে বাক্য দিলুঁ, — কেমতে সত্য হয় ।
স্ত্রী, পুত্র, জ্ঞাতি, বন্ধু জানিবে নিশ্চয় ॥ ৩৬ ॥

tīrthe vipre vākya diluṁ, — kemate satya haya
at the holy place to the brāhmaṇa word I gave how true becomes
strī, putra, jñāti, bandhu jānibe niścaya
wife son kinsmen friends will know surely

36 “At a holy place I gave my word to a brāhmaṇa — how can I make it true? My wife, my son, my kinsmen and friends will surely come to know of it.”

একদিন নিজ-লোক একত্র করিল ।
তা-সবার আগে সব বৃত্তান্ত কহিল ॥ ৩৭ ॥

ekadina nija-loka ekatra karila
one day own people together gathered
tā-sabāra āge saba vṛttānta kahila
of them all before whole story told

37 One day he gathered his family together and told them the whole story.

শুনি, সব গোষ্ঠী তার করে হাহাকার ।
ঐছে বাত্ মুখে তুমি না আনিবে আর ॥ ৩৮ ॥

śuni, saba goṣṭhī tāra kare hāhā-kāra
hearing all relatives his make lamentation
aiche bāt mukhe tumi nā ānibe āra
such words to your mouth you not will bring again

38 Hearing it, all his relatives cried out in dismay: “Never let such words pass your lips again!

নীচে কন্যা দিলে কুল যাইবেক নাশ ।
শুনিঞা সকল লোক করিবে উপহাস ॥ ৩৯ ॥

nīce kanyā dile kula yāibeka nāśa
to a lowly man daughter if you give family will go to ruin
śuniñā sakala loka karibe upahāsa
hearing all people will make mockery

39 If you give your daughter to a lowly man, our family will be ruined, and everyone who hears of it will laugh at us.”

বিপ্র বলে, — তীর্থ-বাক্য কেমনে করি আন ।
যে হউক্, সে হউক্ আমি দিব কন্যাদান ॥ ৪০ ॥

vipra bale, — tīrtha-vākya kemane kari āna
the brāhmaṇa says word given at a holy place how I make otherwise
ye hauk, se hauk āmi diba kanyā-dāna
what may be that may be I shall give the gift of a daughter

40 The brāhmaṇa said, “How can I break a promise made at a holy place? Come what may, I shall give her in marriage.”

জ্ঞাতি লোক কহে, — মোরা তোমাকে ছাড়িব ।
স্ত্রী-পুত্র কহে, — বিষ খাইয়া মরিব ॥ ৪১ ॥

jñāti loka kahe, — morā tomāke chāḍiba
kinsmen people say we you will abandon
strī-putra kahe, — viṣa khāiyā mariba
wife and son say poison eating will die

41 His kinsmen said, “Then we shall disown you,” and his wife and son said, “We shall take poison and die.”

বিপ্র বলে, — সাক্ষী বোলাঞা করিবেক ন্যায় ।
জিতি’ কন্যা লবে, মোর ব্যর্থ ধর্ম্ম হয় ॥ ৪২ ॥

vipra bale, — sākṣī bolāñā karibeka nyāya
the brāhmaṇa says the witness calling will make judgement
jiti’ kanyā labe, mora vyartha dharma haya
winning daughter will take my vain dharma becomes

42 The brāhmaṇa said, “He will call his witness and have the matter judged. He will win and take my daughter, and my dharma will come to nothing.”

Anubhāṣya.
The elder brāhmaṇa said: “If I do not give my daughter to the younger brāhmaṇa as I promised, he will call the Deity Śrī Gopāla as witness and win my daughter by force. Then my *dharma* will prove fruitless.”

পুত্র বলে, — প্রতিমা সাক্ষী, সেহ দূর দেশে ।
কে তোমার সাক্ষী দিবে, চিন্তা কর কিসে ॥ ৪৩ ॥

putra bale, — pratimā sākṣī, seha dūra deśe
the son says an image the witness and it in a far land
ke tomāra sākṣī dibe, cintā kara kise
who your witness will give worry you make why

43 His son said, “The witness is only an image, and it is in a distant land. Who will bear witness against you? Why worry?

নাহি কহি, — না কহিও এ মিথ্যা-বচন ।
সবে কহিবে, মোর কিছু নাহিক স্মরণ ॥ ৪৪ ॥

nāhi kahi, — nā kahio e mithyā-vacana
not I said not say this lie
sabe kahibe, mora kichu nāhika smaraṇa
only say my any not remembrance

44 You need not say, ‘I never said it’ — don’t tell that lie. Just say, ‘I remember nothing.’

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Do not tell such a lie as “I did not say I would give my daughter”; say only, “I do not remember it.”

তুমি যদি কহ, — আমি কিছুই না জানি ।
তবে আমি ন্যায় করি’ ব্রাহ্মণেরে জিনি’ ॥ ৪৫ ॥

tumi yadi kaha, — āmi kichui nā jāni
you if say I anything not know
tabe āmi nyāya kari’ brāhmaṇere jini’
then I argument making the brāhmaṇa will defeat

45 If you say, ‘I know nothing about it,’ I will argue the case and defeat the brāhmaṇa.”

Anubhāṣya.

The elder brāhmaṇa's son was a godless man (*nāstika*), a *smārta*, clever in worldly affairs but foolish. He did not believe that the Śrī Vigraha is conscious and all-pervading (*vibhu*), and like an idolater he regarded the Śrī Vigraha as stone and wood. So he said to his father: “First of all, the witness is an image (*pratimā*), so one cannot believe that it will speak like a living being. Besides, it is very far away, so giving testimony here from such a distance is impossible for it. Therefore do not worry about anything. Do not deny your promise outright with a plain lie. Just as King Yudhiṣṭhira said, ‘Aśvatthāmā is slain — the elephant,’ say only, or let it appear, that you cannot remember anything — that is, that you know nothing about it. Then I will trap the younger brāhmaṇa in the snare of false arguments (*kutarka*) and defeat him. And I will rescue you before everyone from the calamity of having to give away your daughter, without letting your promise be broken, and so preserve the honor of our family.” ***Nyāya*** means argument (*tarka*).

এত শুনি’ বিপ্রের চিন্তিত হৈল মন ।
একান্তভাবে চিন্তে বিপ্র গোপাল-চরণ ॥ ৪৬ ॥

eta śuni’ viprera cintita haila mana
thus hearing the brāhmaṇa’s troubled became mind
ekānta-bhāve cinte vipra gopāla-caraṇa
single-mindedly meditates the brāhmaṇa on Gopāla’s feet

46 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa grew troubled, and with all his heart he meditated on Gopāla’s feet:

মোর ধর্ম্ম রক্ষা পায়, না মরে নিজ-জন ।
দুই রক্ষা কর, গোপাল, লইনু শরণ ॥ ৪৭ ॥

mora dharma rakṣā pāya, nā mare nija-jana
my dharma protection gets not die own people
dui rakṣā kara, gopāla, lainu śaraṇa
both protection do Gopāla I have taken shelter

47 “Let my dharma be kept, and let my family not die. O Gopāla, protect them both — I have taken shelter of You.”

এইমত বিপ্র চিত্তে চিন্তিতে লাগিল ।
আর দিন লঘুবিপ্র তাঁর ঘরে আইল ॥ ৪৮ ॥

ei-mata vipra citte cintite lāgila
in this way the brāhmaṇa in his heart to ponder began
āra dina laghu-vipra tāṁra ghare āila
next day the younger brāhmaṇa his to house came

48 So the brāhmaṇa pondered within himself. The next day the younger brāhmaṇa came to his house.

আসিয়া পরম-ভক্ত্যে নমস্কার করি' ।
বিনয় করিঞা কহে কর দুই যুড়ি' ॥ ৪৯ ॥

āsiyā parama-bhaktye namaskāra kari'
coming with great devotion obeisance making
vinaya kariñā kahe kara dui yuḍi'
humility showing says hands both joining

49 He came in, bowed down with deep devotion, and with folded hands humbly said:

তুমি মোরে কন্যা দিতে কর্যাছ অঙ্গীকার ।
এবে কিছু নাহি কহ, কি তোমার ব্যবহার' ॥ ৫০ ॥

tumi more kanyā dite karyācha aṅgīkāra
you to me daughter to give have made promise
ebe kichu nāhi kaha, ki tomāra vyavahāra'
now anything not you say what your conduct

50 "You promised to give me your daughter. Now you say nothing at all. What kind of conduct is this?"[4]

এত শুনি' সেই বিপ্র রহে মৌন ধরি' ।
তাঁর পুত্র মারিতে আইল হাতে ঠেঙ্গা করি' ॥ ৫১ ॥

eta śuni' sei vipra rahe mauna dhari'
thus hearing that brāhmaṇa remains silence keeping
tāṁra putra mārite āila hāte ṭheṅgā kari'
his son to beat came in his hand a stick taking

51 Hearing this, the brāhmaṇa kept silent, and his son came at the young man with a stick in his hand to beat him.

অরে অধম! মোর ভগ্নী চাহ বিবাহিতে ৷
বামন হঞা চন্দ্রে যেন চাহ ত' ধরিতে ॥ ৫২ ॥

are adhama! mora bhagnī cāha vivāhite
you wretch my sister you want to marry
vāmana hañā candre yena cāha ta' dharite
a dwarf being the moon as if you want indeed to catch

52 "You wretch! You want to marry my sister? You are like a dwarf who wants to catch the moon!"

ঠেঙ্গা দেখি' সেই বিপ্র পলাঞা গেল ৷
আর দিন গ্রামের লোক একত্র করিল ॥ ৫৩ ॥

ṭheṅgā dekhi' sei vipra palāñā gela
the stick seeing that brāhmaṇa fleeing went
āra dina grāmera loka ekatra karila
next day of the village the people together gathered

53 Seeing the stick, the young brāhmaṇa ran away. The next day he gathered the people of the village.

সব লোক বড়বিপ্রে ডাকিয়া আনিল ৷
তবে সেই লঘুবিপ্র কহিতে লাগিল ॥ ৫৪ ॥

saba loka baḍa-vipre ḍākiyā ānila
all the people the elder brāhmaṇa calling brought
tabe sei laghu-vipra kahite lāgila
then that younger brāhmaṇa to speak began

54 The people sent for the elder brāhmaṇa and brought him there, and then the younger brāhmaṇa began to speak:

ইঁহো মোরে কন্যা দিতে কর্যাছে অঙ্গীকার ।
এবে যে না দেন, পুছ ইঁহার ব্যবহার ॥ ৫৫ ॥

iṁho more kanyā dite karyāche aṅgīkāra
he to me daughter to give has made promise
ebe ye nā dena, pucha iṁhāra vyavahāra
now that not he gives ask his conduct

55 "This man promised to give me his daughter. Now he will not give her — ask him why he behaves like this."

তবে সেই বিপ্রেরে পুছিল সর্ব্বজন ।
কন্যা কেনে না দেহ, যদি দিয়াছ বচন' ॥ ৫৬ ॥

tabe sei viprere puchila sarva-jana
then that brāhmaṇa asked all the people
kanyā kene nā deha, yadi diyācha vacana'
daughter why not you give if you have given word

56 Then everyone asked the brāhmaṇa, "If you gave your word, why do you not give him your daughter?"

বিপ্র কহে, — শুন, লোক, মোর নিবেদন ।
কবে কি বলিয়াছি, মোর নাহিক স্মরণ ॥ ৫৭ ॥

vipra kahe, — śuna, loka, mora nivedana
the brāhmaṇa says hear people my submission
kabe ki baliyāchi, mora nāhika smaraṇa
when what I have said my there is not remembrance

57 The brāhmaṇa said, "Listen, good people, to what I have to say: I do not remember ever saying such a thing."

এত শুনি' তাঁর পুত্র বাক্য-ছল পাঞা ।
প্রগল্ভ হইয়া কহে সম্মুখে আসিঞা ॥ ৫৮ ॥

eta śuni' tāṁra putra vākya-chala pāñā
thus hearing his son a quibble in the words finding
pragalbha haiyā kahe sammukhe āsiñā
brazen becoming speaks in front coming

58 Hearing this, his son found in his father's words a pretext for a quibble. He came forward and spoke out brazenly:

Anubhāṣya.
Chala (quibbling). When a speaker uses a word in one sense and the opponent, rejecting that sense, invents a contrary one and makes false charges, that is *chala*.

তীর্থযাত্রায় পিতার সঙ্গে ছিল বহু ধন ।
ধন দেখি' এই দুষ্টের লৈতে হৈল মন ॥ ৫৯ ॥

tīrtha-yātrāya pitāra saṅge chila bahu dhana
on the pilgrimage father with was much money
dhana dekhi' ei duṣṭera laite haila mana
money seeing this scoundrel's to take became desire

59 "On the pilgrimage my father carried a great deal of money. When this scoundrel saw it, he wanted to take it.

আর কেহ সঙ্গে নাহি, এই সঙ্গে একল ।
ধুতুরা খাওয়াঞা বাপে করিল পাগল ॥ ৬০ ॥

āra keha saṅge nāhi, ei saṅge ekala
other anyone with not this one with alone
dhuturā khāoyāñā bāpe karila pāgala
dhuturā feeding father made mad

60 There was no one else with my father — only this man. He fed him *dhuturā* and drove him out of his mind.

সব ধন লঞা কহে, ‘চোরে লইল ধন’ ৷
কন্যা দিতে চাহিয়াছে উঠাইল বচন ॥ ৬১ ॥

saba dhana lañā kahe, ‘core laila dhana’
all money taking says a thief took the money
kanyā dite cāhiyāche uṭhāila vacana
daughter to give he wanted raised word

61 He took all the money and blamed it on a thief. And now he puts about the story that my father wanted to give him his daughter.

তোমরা সকল লোক করহ বিচারে ৷
মোর পিতার কন্যা দিতে যোগ্য কি ইহারে ॥ ৬২ ॥

tomarā sakala loka karaha vicāre
you all people make judgement
mora pitāra kanyā dite yogya ki ihāre
my father’s daughter to give fit is to him

62 All of you, good people, judge for yourselves: is this man fit to receive my father’s daughter?”

এত শুনি’ লোকের মনে হইল সংশয় ৷
সম্ভবে, — ধনলোভে লোক ছাড়ে ধর্ম্মভয় ॥ ৬৩ ॥

eta śuni’ lokera mane haila saṁśaya
thus hearing people’s in minds arose doubt
sambhave, — dhana-lobhe loka chāḍe dharma-bhaya
possible from greed for money people give up fear of dharma

63 Hearing this, the people began to have doubts: “It may well be so — greed for money makes people lose their fear of dharma.”

Anubhāṣya.
Greed for wealth makes people lose all discrimination between *dharma* and *adharma*. So the people suspected: “At that time the younger brāhmaṇa, out of greed for money, may even have done violence to the elder brāhmaṇa.”

তবে ছোটবিপ্র কহে, — শুন, মহাজন ।
ন্যায় জিনিবারে কহে অসত্য-বচন ॥ ৬৪ ॥

tabe choṭa-vipra kahe, — śuna, mahājana
then the younger brāhmaṇa says listen honourable people
nyāya jinibāre kahe asatya-vacana
argument to win he speaks false words

64 Then the younger brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, honourable people! He is telling lies to win the argument.

এই বিপ্র মোর সেবায় তুষ্ট যবে হৈলা ।
তোরে আমি কন্যা দিব আপনে কহিলা ॥ ৬৫ ॥

ei vipra mora sevāya tuṣṭa yabe hailā
this brāhmaṇa my with service pleased when became
tore āmi kanyā diba āpane kahilā
to you I daughter shall give himself said

65 When this brāhmaṇa was pleased with my service, he himself said, ‘I shall give you my daughter.’

তবে মুঞি নিষেধিনু, — শুন, দ্বিজবর ।
তোমার কন্যার যোগ্য নহি মুঞি বর ॥ ৬৬ ॥

tabe muñi niṣedhinu, — śuna, dvija-vara
then I forbade listen best of the twice-born
tomāra kanyāra yogya nahi muñi vara
your daughter’s fit not am I bridegroom

66 But I tried to dissuade him: ‘Listen, best of the twice-born: I am not a fit husband for your daughter.

কাঁহা তুমি পণ্ডিত, ধনী, পরম-কুলীন ।
কাঁহা মুঞি দরিদ্র, মূর্খ, নীচ, কুলহীন ॥ ৬৭ ॥

kāṁhā tumi paṇḍita, dhanī, parama-kulīna
where you learned rich most noble
kāṁhā muñi daridra, mūrkha, nīca, kula-hīna
where I poor ignorant lowly without family

67 You are learned, rich and of the noblest family; I am poor, ignorant and lowly, a man of no family. How can we compare?'

তবু এই বিপ্র মোরে কহে বার বার ।
তোরে কন্যা দিব, তুমি করহ স্বীকার ॥ ৬৮ ॥

tabu ei vipra more kahe bāra bāra
still this brāhmaṇa to me says time after time
tore kanyā diba, tumi karaha svīkāra
to you daughter I shall give you do acceptance

68 Still this brāhmaṇa told me again and again, 'I shall give you my daughter; you must accept her.'

তবে আমি কহিলাঙ — শুন, মহামতি ।
তোমার স্ত্রী-পুত্র-জ্ঞাতির না হবে সম্মতি ॥ ৬৯ ॥

tabe āmi kahilāṅa — śuna, mahā-mati
then I said listen wise one
tomāra strī-putra-jñātira nā habe sammati
your of wife, son and kinsmen not will be consent

69 Then I said, 'Listen, wise sir: your wife, your son and your kinsmen will never consent.

কন্যা দিতে নারিবে, হবে অসত্য-বচন ।
পুনরপি কহে বিপ্র করিয়া যতন ॥ ৭০ ॥

kanyā dite nāribe, habe asatya-vacana
daughter to give you will not be able will be false word
punarapi kahe vipra kariyā yatana
again says the brāhmaṇa making effort

70 You will not be able to give her, and your word will turn out false.' But the brāhmaṇa insisted once more:

কন্যা তোরে দিব, দ্বিধা না করিহ চিত্তে ।
আত্মকন্যা দিব, কেবা পারে নিষেধিতে ॥ ৭১ ॥

kanyā tore diba, dvidhā nā kariha citte
daughter to you I shall give hesitation not make in heart
ātma-kanyā diba, kebā pāre niṣedhite
own daughter I shall give who can forbid

71 'I shall give my daughter to you; have no doubt in your heart. It is my own daughter I am giving — who can forbid me?'

তবে আমি কহিলাঙ, দৃঢ় করি' মন ।
গোপালের আগে কহ এ-সত্য বচন ॥ ৭২ ॥

tabe āmi kahilāṅa, dṛḍha kari' mana
then I said firm making mind
gopālera āge kaha e-satya vacana
Gopāla's before say these true words

72 Then, with my mind made firm, I said, 'Say these true words before Gopāla.'

তবে ইঁহো গোপালের আগেতে কহিল ।
তুমি জান, এই বিপ্রে কন্যা আমি দিল ॥ ৭৩ ॥

tabe iṁho gopālera āgete kahila
then he Gopāla's before said
tumi jāna, ei vipre kanyā āmi dila
You know to this brāhmaṇa daughter I gave

73 So he declared before Gopāla, 'You know it: I have given my daughter to this brāhmaṇa.'

তবে আমি গোপালেরে সাক্ষি করিঞা ।
কহিলাঙ তাঁর পদে প্রণত হঞা ॥ ৭৪ ॥

tabe āmi gopālere sākṣi kariñā
then I Gopāla witness making
kahilāṅa tāṁra pade praṇata hañā
said at His feet bowed being

74 Then I made Gopāla my witness, bowed down at His feet and said:

যদি এই বিপ্র মোরে না দিবে কন্যাদান ।
সাক্ষি বোলাইমু তোমায়, হইও সাবধান ॥ ৭৫ ॥

yadi ei vipra more nā dibe kanyā-dāna
if this brāhmaṇa to me not will give the gift of a daughter
sākṣi bolāimu tomāya, haio sāvadhāna
as witness I will call You be ready

75 'If this brāhmaṇa does not give me his daughter, I shall call on You as my witness. Be ready for that.'

এই বাক্যে সাক্ষি মোর আছে মহাজন ।
যাঁর বাক্য সত্য করি' মানে ত্রিভুবন ॥ ৭৬ ॥

ei vākye sākṣi mora āche mahājana
in this word witness my is a great personage
yāṁra vākya satya kari' māne tribhuvana
whose word true taking accept the three worlds

76 So in this matter my witness is the Lord Himself, whose word the three worlds accept as truth."

Anubhāṣya.
Mahājana — the Deity (*devatā*).

তবে বড়বিপ্র কহে, — এই সত্য কথা ।
গোপাল যদি সাক্ষি দেন, আপনে আসি' এথা ॥ ৭৭ ॥

তবে কন্যা দিব আমি, জানিহ নিশ্চয় ।
তাঁর পুত্র কহে, — এই ভাল বাত হয় ॥ ৭৮ ॥

tabe baḍa-vipra kahe, — ei satya kathā
then the elder brāhmaṇa says this true word
gopāla yadi sākṣi dena, āpane āsi' ethā
Gopāla if witness gives Himself coming here
tabe kanyā diba āmi, jāniha niścaya"
then daughter will give I know for certain
tāṁra putra kahe, — ei bhāla bāta haya
his son says this good word is

77–78 Then the elder brāhmaṇa said, "Very well. If Gopāla comes here Himself and bears witness, then I will give my daughter — know this for certain." His son said, "That is a fair arrangement."

বড়বিপ্রের মনে, — কৃষ্ণ বড় দয়াবান্ ।
অবশ্য মোর বাক্য তিঁহো করিবে প্রমাণ ॥ ৭৯ ॥

baḍa-viprera mane, — 'kṛṣṇa baḍa dayāvān
in the elder brāhmaṇa's mind Kṛṣṇa very merciful
avaśya mora vākya tiṁho karibe pramāṇa'
surely my word He will make proven

79 The elder brāhmaṇa thought, "Kṛṣṇa is most merciful. He will surely prove my words true."

পুত্রের মনে, — প্রতিমা না আসিবে সাক্ষি দিতে ।
এই বুদ্ধ্যে দুইজন হইয়া সম্মতে ॥ ৮০ ॥

putrera mane, — 'pratimā nā āsibe sākṣi dite'
in the son's mind an image not will come witness to give
ei buddhye dui-jana haiyā sammate
with this thought the two being in agreement

80 The son thought, "An image will never come to bear witness." Each with his own thought, the two of them agreed.

ছোটবিপ্র বলে, — পত্র করহ লিখন ।
পুনঃ যেন নাহি চলে এসব বচন ॥ ৮১ ॥

choṭa-vipra bale, — ‘patra karaha likhana
the younger brāhmaṇa says a document make writing
punaḥ yena nāhi cale esaba vacana’
again so that not be retracted all these words

81 The younger brāhmaṇa said, “Put it down in writing, so that these words cannot be taken back again.”

তবে সব লোক মেলি’ পত্র ত’ লিখিল ।
দুঁহার সম্মতি লঞা মধ্যস্থ রাখিল ॥ ৮২ ॥

tabe saba loka meli’ patra ta’ likhila
then all the people gathering document indeed wrote
duṁhāra sammati lañā madhyastha rākhila
of both consent taking with an arbiter kept

82 Then all the people together wrote out the document, took the consent of both, and left it in the keeping of an arbiter.

তবে ছোটবিপ্র কহে, — শুন, সর্ব্বজন ।
এই বিপ্র — সত্য-বাক্, ধর্ম্ম-পরায়ণ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

tabe choṭa-vipra kahe, — śuna, sarva-jana
then the younger brāhmaṇa says listen all people
ei vipra — satya-vāk, dharma-parāyaṇa
this brāhmaṇa truthful in speech devoted to dharma

83 Then the younger brāhmaṇa said, “Listen, everyone: this brāhmaṇa is truthful and devoted to dharma.

স্ববাক্য ছাড়িতে ইঁহার নাহি কভু মন ।
স্বজন-মৃত্যু-ভয়ে কহে অসত্য-বচন ॥ ৮৪ ॥

sva-vākya chāḍite iṁhāra nāhi kabhu mana
own word to abandon his not ever mind
svajana-mṛtyu-bhaye kahe asatya-vacana
from fear of his family's death he speaks false words

84 He never wished to go back on his word; he speaks falsely only because he fears his family will die.

ইঁহার পুণ্যে কৃষ্ণে আনি' সাক্ষি বোলাইব ।
তবে এই বিপ্রের সত্য-প্রতিজ্ঞা রাখিব ॥ ৮৫ ॥

iṁhāra puṇye kṛṣṇe āni' sākṣi bolāiba
by his piety Kṛṣṇa bringing as witness I shall call
tabe ei viprera satya-pratijñā rākhiba
then this brāhmaṇa's true promise I shall keep

85 By the power of his piety I shall bring Kṛṣṇa here and call Him as witness, and so I shall keep this brāhmaṇa's true promise."

এত শুনি' নাস্তিক লোক উপহাস করে ।
কেহ বলে, ঈশ্বর — দয়ালু, আসিতেহ পারে ॥ ৮৬ ॥

eta śuni' nāstika loka upahāsa kare
thus hearing atheistic people mockery make
keha bale, īśvara — dayālu, āsiteha pāre
some say God merciful to come even He can

86 Hearing this, the atheists laughed, but some said, "God is merciful — He may well come."

Anubhāṣya.

Godless (*nāstika*), because they did not believe that Kṛṣṇa is the Supreme Lord and loves His devotees, and so regarded His *arcā-vigraha* as mere earth.

তবে সেই ছোটবিপ্র গেলা বৃন্দাবন ।
দণ্ডবৎ করি' কহে সব বিবরণ ॥ ৮৭ ॥

tabe sei choṭa-vipra gelā vṛndāvana
then that younger brāhmaṇa went to Vṛndāvana
daṇḍavat kari' kahe saba vivaraṇa
prostration making tells all the account

87 Then the younger brāhmaṇa went to Vṛndāvana, bowed down flat before Gopāla and told Him everything in detail:

ব্রহ্মণ্য-দেব তুমি — বড় দয়াময় ।
দুইবিপ্রের ধর্ম্ম রাখ হঞা সদয় ॥ ৮৮ ॥

brahmaṇya-deva tumi — baḍa dayā-maya
Lord of the brāhmaṇas You very full of mercy
duiviprera dharma rākha hañā sadaya
of the two brāhmaṇas dharma protect being kind

88 "You are the Lord of the brāhmaṇas, and You are most merciful. Be kind and protect the dharma of two brāhmaṇas.

কন্যা পাব, — মোর মনে ইহা নাহি সুখ ।
ব্রাহ্মণের প্রতিজ্ঞা যায়, — এই বড় দুঃখ ॥ ৮৯ ॥

kanyā pāba, — mora mane ihā nāhi sukha
daughter I shall get in my mind in this there is not joy
brāhmaṇera pratijñā yāya, — ei baḍa duḥkha
a brāhmaṇa's promise is lost this great sorrow

89 I take no joy in the thought that I shall get his daughter. What grieves me deeply is that a brāhmaṇa's promise is being broken.

Anubhāṣya.
"I am not asking You to give testimony so that, by marrying the elder brāhmaṇa's daughter, I may gratify my own senses and increase my pleasures. I am asking You only to save Your devotee, the elder brāhmaṇa, from the sin of breaking his promise and to keep his word true."

এত জানি' তুমি সাক্ষি দেহ, দয়াময় ।
জানি' সাক্ষি নাহি দেয়, তার পাপ হয় ॥ ৯০ ॥

eta jāni' tumi sākṣi deha, dayā-maya
thus knowing You witness give merciful one
jāni' sākṣi nāhi deya, tāra pāpa haya
knowing witness not gives his sin is

90 Knowing this, O merciful Lord, bear witness. One who knows the truth and does not bear witness incurs sin."

কৃষ্ণ কহে, — বিপ্র, তুমি যাহ স্ব-ভবনে ।
সভা করি' মোরে তুমি করিহ স্মরণে ॥ ৯১ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahe, — vipra, tumi yāha sva-bhavane
Kṛṣṇa says brāhmaṇa you go to your own home
sabhā kari' more tumi kariha smaraṇe
assembly making Me you do remembrance

91 Kṛṣṇa said, "Brāhmaṇa, go back to your home. Call the people together, and then remember Me.

আবির্ভাব হঞা আমি তাঁহা সাক্ষি দিব ।
তবে দুই বিপ্রের সত্য-প্রতিজ্ঞা রাখিব ॥ ৯২ ॥

āvirbhāva hañā āmi tāṁhā sākṣi diba
manifest becoming I there witness shall give
tabe dui viprera satya-pratijñā rākhiba
then of the two brāhmaṇas true promise I shall keep

92 I shall appear there and bear witness, and so I shall keep the true promise of both brāhmaṇas."

বিপ্র বলে, — যদি হও চতুর্ভুজ-মূর্ত্তি ।
তবু তোমার বাক্যে কারু না হবে প্রতীতি ॥ ৯৩ ॥

vipra bale, — yadi hao caturbhuja-mūrti
the brāhmaṇa says if You become a four-armed form
tabu tomāra vākye kāru nā habe pratīti
still Your words to anyone not will be belief

93 The brāhmaṇa said, “Even if You appear in a four-armed form, no one will believe Your words.

এই মূর্ত্তি গিয়া, যদি এই শ্রীবদনে ।
সাক্ষি দেহ যদি, — তবে সর্ব্বলোক শুনে ॥ ৯৪ ॥

ei mūrti giyā, yadi ei śrī-vadane
this form going if with this holy mouth
sākṣi deha yadi, — tabe sarva-loka śune
witness You give if then all people hear

94 But if You go in this very form and bear witness with these very lips, then everyone will listen.”

কৃষ্ণ কহে, — প্রতিমা চলে, কোথাহ না শুনি ।
বিপ্র বলে, — প্রতিমা হঞা কহ কেনে বাণী ॥ ৯৫ ॥

kṛṣṇa kahe, — pratimā cale, kothāha nā śuni
Kṛṣṇa says an image walks anywhere not I hear
vipra bale, — pratimā hañā kaha kene vāṇī
the brāhmaṇa says an image being You speak why words

95 Kṛṣṇa said, “Who has ever heard of an image walking?” The brāhmaṇa replied, “Then why do You speak, if You are an image?

প্রতিমা নহ তুমি, — সাক্ষাৎ ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ।
বিপ্র লাগি’ কর তুমি অকার্য্য-করণ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

pratimā naha tumi, — sākṣāt vrajendra-nandana
an image not are You directly the son of the king of Vraja
vipra lāgi’ kara tumi akārya-karaṇa
a brāhmaṇa for the sake of do You of the undoable the doing

96 You are no image — You are the son of the king of Vraja Himself. For a brāhmaṇa's sake You do even what You would never otherwise do."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
For the good of a brāhmaṇa You do all that is otherwise not fitting for You to do.

Anubhāṣya.
Bhagavān asked this question to test the younger brāhmaṇa and to free him from a charge: no one should think him an "idolater" (*pauttalika*) — one who regards the *arcā-vigraha* of Viṣṇu as stone and wood, is devoted to knowledge born of the senses, and lives for the body. And the brāhmaṇa answered like a true devotee who believes that Viṣṇu, the Lord of all lords, is God.

হাসিঞা গোপাল কহে, — শুনহ, ব্রাহ্মণ ।
তোমার পাছে পাছে আমি করিব গমন ॥ ৯৭ ॥

hāsiñā gopāla kahe, — śunaha, brāhmaṇa
smiling Gopāla says listen brāhmaṇa
tomāra pāche pāche āmi kariba gamana
you behind behind I shall make going

97 Gopāla smiled and said, "Listen, brāhmaṇa: I shall walk behind you.

উলটিয়া আমা না করিহ দরশনে ।
আমাকে দেখিলে, আমি রহিব সেই স্থানে ॥ ৯৮ ॥

ulaṭiyā āmā nā kariha daraśane
turning round Me not do looking
āmāke dekhile, āmi rahiba sei sthāne
Me if you see I shall stay that place

98 Do not turn round to look at Me. If you see Me, I shall stay on that very spot.

নূপুরের ধ্বনিমাত্র আমার শুনিবা ।
সেই শব্দে আমার গমন প্রতীতি করিবা ॥ ৯৯ ॥

nūpurera dhvani-mātra āmāra śunibā
of the ankle bells only the sound My you will hear
sei śabde āmāra gamana pratīti karibā
by that sound My going assurance you will make

99 You will hear only the sound of My ankle bells, and by that sound you will know that I am following.

এক সের অন্ন রান্ধি' করিহ সমর্পণ ।
তাহা খাঞা তোমার সঙ্গে করিব গমন ॥ ১০০ ॥

eka sera anna rāndhi' kariha samarpaṇa
one ser rice cooking make offering
tāhā khāñā tomāra saṅge kariba gamana
that eating you with I shall make going

100 Cook one *ser* of rice each day and offer it to Me. I shall eat it and walk on with you."

আর দিন আজ্ঞা মাগি' চলিলা ব্রাহ্মণ ।
তার পাছে পাছে গোপাল করিলা গমন ॥ ১০১ ॥

āra dina ājñā māgi' calilā brāhmaṇa
next day permission begging set out the brāhmaṇa
tāra pāche pāche gopāla karilā gamana
him behind behind Gopāla made going

101 The next day the brāhmaṇa took his leave and set out, and Gopāla walked behind him.

নূপুরের ধ্বনি শুনি' আনন্দিত মন ।
উত্তমান্ন পাক করি' করায় ভোজন ॥ ১০২ ॥

nūpurera dhvani śuni' ānandita mana
of the ankle bells the sound hearing joyful his heart
uttamānna pāka kari' karāya bhojana
the finest rice cooking making he makes Him eat

102 As he heard the sound of the ankle bells, his heart was full of joy, and he cooked the finest rice and fed Him.

এইমতে চলি’ বিপ্র নিজ-দেশে আইলা ।
গ্রামের নিকট আসি’ মনেতে চিন্তিলা ॥ ১০৩ ॥

ei-mate cali’ vipra nija-deśe āilā
in this way walking the brāhmaṇa to his own country came
grāmera nikaṭa āsi’ manete cintilā
the village near coming in mind he thought

103 Travelling like this, the brāhmaṇa reached his own country, and as he drew near his village he thought:

এবে মুঞি গ্রামে আইনু, যাইমু ভবন ।
লোকেরে কহিব গিয়া সাক্ষির আগমন ॥ ১০৪ ॥

ebe muñi grāme āinu, yāimu bhavana
now I to the village have come I shall go home
lokere kahiba giyā sākṣira āgamana
to the people I shall tell going of the witness the coming

104 “Now I have come to the village. I shall go home and tell the people that the witness has come.[5]

সাক্ষাতে না দেখিলে মনে প্রতীতি না হয় ।
ইঁহা যদি রহেন, তবু কিছু নাহি ভয় ॥ ১০৫ ॥

sākṣāte nā dekhile mane pratīti nā haya
with their own eyes not if they see in mind belief not is
iṁhā yadi rahena, tabu kichu nāhi bhaya
here if He stays still any not fear

105 Unless they see Him with their own eyes, they will not believe. Even if He stays here, there is nothing to fear.”

এত ভাবি’ সেই বিপ্র ফিরিয়া চাহিল ।
হাসিঞা গোপাল-দেব তথায় রহিল ॥ ১০৬ ॥

eta bhāvi’ sei vipra phiriyā cāhila
thus thinking that brāhmaṇa turning round looked
hāsiñā gopāla-deva tathāya rahila
smiling Gopāladeva there stayed

106 With this thought the brāhmaṇa turned round and looked, and Gopāladeva, smiling, stayed right there.

ব্রাহ্মণেরে কহে, — তুমি যাহ নিজ-ঘর ।
এথায় রহিব আমি, না যাব অতঃপর ॥ ১০৭ ॥

brāhmaṇere kahe, — tumi yāha nija-ghara
to the brāhmaṇa says you go own home
ethāya rahiba āmi, nā yāba ataḥpara
here shall stay I not shall go further

107 He said to the brāhmaṇa, “Go home now. I shall stay here; I shall go no further.”

তবে সেই বিপ্র যাই, নগরে কহিল ।
শুনিয়া সকল লোক চমৎকার হৈল ॥ ১০৮ ॥

tabe sei vipra yāi, nagare kahila
then that brāhmaṇa going in the town told
śuniyā sakala loka camatkāra haila
hearing all people astonished became

108 Then the brāhmaṇa went and told the people in the town, and everyone who heard it was astonished.

আইল সকল লোক সাক্ষি দেখিবারে ।
গোপাল দেখিঞা লোক দণ্ডবৎ করে ॥ ১০৯ ॥

āila sakala loka sākṣi dekhibāre
came all people the witness to see
gopāla dekhiñā loka daṇḍavat kare
Gopāla seeing the people prostration make

109 All the people came to see the witness, and when they saw Gopāla they fell flat in obeisance.

গোপাল-সৌন্দর্য্য দেখি' লোকে আনন্দিত ।
প্রতিমা চলিঞা আইলা, — শুনিয়া বিস্মিত ॥ ১১০ ॥

gopāla-saundarya dekhi' loke ānandita
Gopāla's beauty seeing the people joyful
pratimā caliñā āilā, — śuniyā vismita
the Deity walking came hearing amazed

110 The people rejoiced to see Gopāla's beauty, and they were amazed to hear that the Deity had come walking.

তবে সেই বড় বিপ্র আনন্দিত হঞা ।
গোপালের আগে পড়ে দণ্ডবৎ হঞা ॥ ১১১ ॥

tabe sei baḍa vipra ānandita hañā
then that elder brāhmaṇa joyful being
gopālera āge paḍe daṇḍavat hañā
Gopāla's before falls prostrate being

111 Then the elder brāhmaṇa, overjoyed, fell flat before Gopāla in obeisance.

সকল লোকের আগে গোপাল সাক্ষি দিল ।
বড়বিপ্র ছোটবিপ্রে কন্যাদান কৈল ॥ ১১২ ॥

sakala lokera āge gopāla sākṣi dila
all the people's before Gopāla witness gave
baḍa-vipra choṭa-vipre kanyā-dāna kaila
the elder brāhmaṇa to the younger brāhmaṇa gift of his daughter made

112 Before all the people Gopāla bore witness, and the elder brāhmaṇa gave his daughter in marriage to the younger.

তবে সেই দুই বিপ্রে কহিল ঈশ্বর ।
তুমি-দুই — জন্মে-জন্মে আমার কিঙ্কর ॥ ১১৩ ॥

tabe sei dui vipre kahila īśvara
then those two to the brāhmaṇas said the Lord
tumi-dui — janme-janme āmāra kiṅkara
you two birth after birth My servants

113 Then the Lord said to the two brāhmaṇas, "Birth after birth, you two are My servants.

দুঁহার সত্যে তুষ্ট হইলাঙ, দুঁহে মাগ' বর ।
দুই বিপ্র বর মাগে আনন্দ-অন্তর ॥ ১১৪ ॥

duṁhāra satye tuṣṭa hailāṅa, duṁhe māga' vara
of both with the truthfulness pleased I have become both ask a boon
dui vipra vara māge ānanda-antara
two brāhmaṇas a boon ask joyful at heart

114 I am pleased with the truthfulness of you both. Ask Me for a boon." Their hearts full of joy, the two brāhmaṇas asked:

যদি বর দিবে, তবে রহ এই স্থানে ।
কিঙ্করেরে দয়া তব সর্ব্বলোকে জানে ॥ ১১৫ ॥

yadi vara dibe, tabe raha ei sthāne
if a boon You will give then stay this place
kiṅkarere dayā tava sarva-loke jāne
to servants mercy Your all people know

115 "If You will grant us a boon, then stay in this place, so that all the world may know Your mercy to Your servants."

গোপাল রহিলা, দুঁহে করেন সেবন ।
দেখিতে আইলা সব দেশের লোক-জন ॥ ১১৬ ॥

gopāla rahilā, duṁhe karena sevana
Gopāla stayed both do service
dekhite āilā saba deśera loka-jana
to see came all of the land people

116 Gopāla stayed, and the two of them served Him. People came from all over the land to see Him.

The story of Śrī Gopāla and Puruṣottama, the king of Utkala —

সে দেশের রাজা আইল আশ্চর্য্য শুনিঞা ।
পরম সন্তোষ পাইল গোপালে দেখিঞা ॥ ১১৭ ॥

se deśera rājā āila āścarya śuniñā
of that land the king came of the wonder hearing
parama santoṣa pāila gopāle dekhiñā
supreme satisfaction got Gopāla seeing

117 Hearing of this wonder, the king of that land came, and he was supremely pleased to see Gopāla.

মন্দির করিয়া রাজা সেবা চালাইল ।
'সাক্ষিগোপাল' বলি' তাঁর নাম খ্যাতি হৈল ॥ ১১৮ ॥

mandira kariyā rājā sevā cālāila
temple making the king service set going
'sākṣi-gopāla' bali' tāṁra nāma khyāti haila
Sākṣi-gopāla calling His name fame became

118 The king built a temple and established His worship, and the Lord became famous by the name Sākṣi-gopāla.

এই মত বিদ্যানগরে সাক্ষিগোপাল ।
সেবা অঙ্গীকার করি' আছেন চিরকাল ॥ ১১৯ ॥

ei mata vidyānagare sākṣi-gopāla
in this way in Vidyānagara Sākṣi-gopāla
sevā aṅgīkāra kari' āchena cira-kāla
service acceptance making remains for a long time

119 So Sākṣi-gopāla remained in Vidyānagara for a long time, accepting the service of His devotees.

Anubhāṣya.

Vidyānagara. The place in the land of Trailaṅga where the Godāvarī River meets the Eastern Sea, the Bay of Bengal, is known as "Koṭadeśa." In that region of the kingdom of Orissa there was a provincial capital named "Vidyānagara." This city stood on the southern bank of the Godāvarī. Puruṣottama, a former king of Utkala, brought that country under his rule and governed it through a provincial governor. Vidyānagara lies twenty to twenty-five miles southeast of present-day Rājamahendrī, which stands on the northern bank of the Godāvarī — that is, on the other bank. In Pratāparudra's time Rāmānanda Rāya was the governor there. Bhijiyānagaram, the village of Bhijiyānā, or Vijayanagara, is not this Vidyānagara.

উৎকলের রাজ — শ্রীপুরুষোত্তম-নাম ।
সেই দেশ জিনি' নিল করিয়া সংগ্রাম ॥ ১২০ ॥

utkalera rāja — śrī-puruṣottama-nāma
of Utkala the king Śrī Puruṣottama by name
sei deśa jini' nila kariyā saṅgrāma
that land conquering took making war

120 The king of Utkala, named Śrī Puruṣottama, made war on that land and conquered it.

সেই রাজা জিনি' নিল তাঁর সিংহাসন ।
'মাণিক্য-সিংহাসন' নাম অনেক রতন ॥ ১২১ ॥

sei rājā jini' nila tāṁra siṁhāsana
that king conquering took his throne
'māṇikya-siṁhāsana' nāma aneka ratana
Māṇikya-siṁhāsana named many jewels

121 The victorious king also took that king's throne, called the Māṇikya-siṁhāsana, which was set with many jewels.

পুরুষোত্তম-দেব সেই বড় ভক্ত আর্য্য ।
গোপাল-চরণে মাগে, — চল মোর রাজ্য ॥ ১২২ ॥

puruṣottama-deva sei baḍa bhakta ārya
Puruṣottama-deva that great devotee noble
gopāla-caraṇe māge, — cala mora rājya
at Gopāla's feet begs come my kingdom

122 That Puruṣottama-deva was a great and noble devotee. At Gopāla's feet he prayed, "Come to my kingdom."

Anubhāṣya.

Rāja[9] — to the kingdom.

তাঁর ভক্তিবশে গোপাল তাঁরে আজ্ঞা দিল ।
গোপাল লঞা সেই কটকে আইল ॥ ১২৩ ॥

tāṁra bhakti-vaśe gopāla tāṁre ājñā dila
his by devotion won over Gopāla to him consent gave
gopāla lañā sei kaṭake āila
Gopāla taking he to Kaṭaka came

123 Won over by his devotion, Gopāla gave His consent, and the king brought Gopāla to Kaṭaka.

জগন্নাথে আনি' দিল মাণিক্য-সিংহাসন ।
কটকে গোপাল-সেবা করিল স্থাপন ॥ ১২৪ ॥

jagannāthe āni' dila māṇikya-siṁhāsana
to Jagannātha bringing gave the Māṇikya-siṁhāsana
kaṭake gopāla-sevā karila sthāpana
in Kaṭaka Gopāla's service made establishment

124 He brought the Māṇikya-siṁhāsana and presented it to Jagannātha, and in Kaṭaka he established the worship of Gopāla.

The story of Śrī Gopāla and the queen —

তাঁহার মহিষী আইলা গোপাল-দর্শনে ।
ভক্তি করি' বহু অলঙ্কার কৈল সমর্পণে ॥ ১২৫ ॥

tāṁhāra mahiṣī āilā gopāla-darśane
his queen came to see Gopāla
bhakti kari' bahu alaṅkāra kaila samarpaṇe
devotion with many ornaments made offering

125 His queen came to see Gopāla, and with devotion she offered Him many ornaments.

তাঁহার নাসাতে বহুমূল্য মুক্তা হয় ।
তাহা দিতে ইচ্ছা হৈল, মনেতে চিন্তয় ॥ ১২৬ ॥

tāṁhāra nāsāte bahu-mūlya muktā haya
her in the nose very costly pearl is
tāhā dite icchā haila, manete cintaya
that to give desire arose in mind she thinks

126 In her nose she wore a very costly pearl, and she wished to give it to Him. She thought:

ঠাকুরের নাসাতে যদি ছিদ্র থাকিত ।
তবে এই দাসী মুক্তা নাসায় পরাইত ॥ ১২৭ ॥

ṭhākurera nāsāte yadi chidra thākita
the Deity's in the nose if a hole there were
tabe ei dāsī muktā nāsāya parāita
then this maidservant pearl in the nose would put

127 "If only there were a hole in the Deity's nose, this maidservant of His could put the pearl in it."

এত চিন্তি' নমস্করি' গেলা স্বভবনে ।
রাত্রিশেষে গোপাল তাঁরে কহেন স্বপনে ॥ ১২৮ ॥

eta cinti' namaskari' gelā sva-bhavane
thus thinking bowing down went to her own home
rātri-śeṣe gopāla tāṁre kahena svapane
at the end of the night Gopāla to her speaks in a dream

128 With this thought she bowed down and went home. At the end of the night Gopāla spoke to her in a dream:

বাল্যকালে মাতা মোর নাসা ছিদ্র করি' ।
মুক্তা পরাঞাছিল বহু যত্ন করি' ॥ ১২৯ ॥

bālya-kāle mātā mora nāsā chidra kari'
in childhood mother My nose hole making
muktā parāñāchila bahu yatna kari'
pearl had put in great care taking

129 "When I was a child, My mother pierced My nose and with great care put a pearl in it.

সেই ছিদ্র অদ্যাপিহ আছয়ে নাসাতে ।
সেই মুক্তা পরাহ, যাহা চাহিয়াছ দিতে ॥ ১৩০ ॥

sei chidra adyāpiha āchaye nāsāte
that hole even now is in the nose
sei muktā parāha, yāhā cāhiyācha dite
that pearl put in which you wanted to give

130 That hole is still there in My nose. Put in it the pearl you wished to give Me."

স্বপ্নে দেখি' সেই রাণী রাজাকে কহিল ।
রাজাসহ মুক্তা লঞা মন্দিরে আইল ॥ ১৩১ ॥

svapne dekhi' sei rāṇī rājāke kahila
in a dream seeing that queen to the king told
rājā-saha muktā lañā mandire āila
with the king pearl taking to the temple came

131 The queen told the king what she had seen in her dream, and she came to the temple with the king, bringing the pearl.

পরাইল মুক্তা নাসায় ছিদ্র দেখিঞা ।
মহামহোৎসব কৈল আনন্দিত হঞা ॥ ১৩২ ॥

parāila muktā nāsāya chidra dekhiñā
put in pearl in the nose hole seeing
mahā-mahotsava kaila ānandita hañā
great festival made joyful being

132 Seeing the hole, they put the pearl in His nose, and in their joy they held a great festival.

সেই হৈতে গোপালের কটকেতে স্থিতি ।
এই লাগি' 'সাক্ষিগোপাল' নাম হৈল খ্যাতি ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

sei haite gopālera kaṭakete sthiti
from that time Gopāla's in Kaṭaka residence
ei lāgi' 'sākṣi-gopāla' nāma haila khyāti
for this reason Sākṣi-gopāla name became famous

133 From that time Gopāla has resided in Kaṭaka, and this is how the name Sākṣi-gopāla became famous.

Hearing from Nitāi's mouth the story of Sākṣi-gopāla, the Lord and His associates rejoice —

নিত্যানন্দ-মুখে শুনি' গোপাল-চরিত ।
তুষ্ট হৈলা মহাপ্রভু স্বভক্ত-সহিত ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

nityānanda-mukhe śuni' gopāla-carita
from Nityānanda's lips hearing Gopāla's story
tuṣṭa hailā mahāprabhu svabhakta-sahita
pleased became Mahāprabhu with His own devotees

134 Hearing the story of Gopāla from Nityānanda's lips, Mahāprabhu and His devotees were delighted.

Seeing the Lord beside Gopāla, the devotees see Them as one —

গোপালের আগে যবে প্রভুর হয় স্থিতি ।
ভক্তগণে দেখে, — যেন দুঁহে একমূর্ত্তি ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

gopālera āge yabe prabhura haya sthiti
Gopāla's before when the Lord's is standing
bhakta-gaṇe dekhe, — yena duṁhe ekamūrti
the devotees see as if both one form

135 When the Lord stood before Gopāla, the devotees saw the two of Them as though They were one and the same form.

দুঁহে — এক বর্ণ, দুঁহে — প্রকাণ্ড-শরীর ।
দুঁহে — রক্তাম্বর, দুঁহার স্বভাব — গম্ভীর ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

duṁhe — eka varṇa, duṁhe — prakāṇḍa-śarīra
both one colour both of massive body
duṁhe — raktāmbara, duṁhāra svabhāva — gambhīra
both in red garments of both the nature grave

136 Both were of one colour, and both had large, majestic bodies; both wore red cloth, and both were grave by nature.

মহা-তেজোময় দুঁহে কমল-নয়ন ।
দুঁহার ভাবাবেশ, দুঁহে — চন্দ্রবদন ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

mahā-tejo-maya duṁhe kamala-nayana
full of great radiance both lotus-eyed
duṁhāra bhāvāveśa, duṁhe — candra-vadana
of both absorption in ecstasy both moon-faced

137 Both shone with great radiance and had lotus eyes; both were absorbed in ecstasy, and both had faces like the moon.

Seeing this, Nitāi laughs merrily with the devotees —

দুঁহা দেখি' নিত্যানন্দপ্রভু মহারঙ্গে ।
ঠারাঠারি করি' হাসে ভক্তগণ-সঙ্গে ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

duṁhā dekhi' nityānanda-prabhu mahā-raṅge
both seeing Nityānanda Prabhu in great delight
ṭhārāṭhāri kari' hāse bhakta-gaṇa-saṅge
signs making laughs with the devotees

138 Seeing the two of Them, Nityānanda Prabhu, in great delight, exchanged knowing glances with the devotees and laughed.

In the morning all set out on the road to Purī —

এইমত মহারঙ্গে সে রাত্রি বঞ্চিঞা ।
প্রভাতে চলিলা মঙ্গল-আরতি দেখিঞা ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

ei-mata mahā-raṅge se rātri vañciñā
in this way in great delight that night passing
prabhāte calilā maṅgala-ārati dekhiñā
in the morning set out maṅgala-ārati seeing

139 So they passed that night in great delight, and in the morning, after seeing the *maṅgala-ārati*, the Lord set out.

*The *darśana* of Bhuvaneśvara and the rest are described in the *Caitanya-*

bhāgavata —*

ভুবনেশ্বর-পথে যৈছে কৈল দরশন ।
বিস্তারি' বর্ণিয়াছেন দাস-বৃন্দাবন ॥ ১৪০ ॥

bhuvaneśvara-pathe yaiche kaila daraśana
on the way to Bhuvaneśvara as made seeing
vistāri' varṇiyāchena dāsa-vṛndāvana
in detail has described Vṛndāvana dāsa

140 What the Lord saw on the way to Bhuvaneśvara, Vṛndāvana dāsa has described in detail.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

See the *Caitanya-bhāgavata*, Antya-līlā, Chapter 2. Leaving Kaṭaka by the royal road, from Bālihastā, or Bālakāṭi-caṭi, to Bhuvaneśvara is two or three *krośas*.

Anubhāṣya.

Caitanya-bhāgavata, Antya, Chapter 2: "Then the Lord came to Śrī Bhuvaneśvara, where Śaṅkara lives in Gupta-kāśī. Here Śiva himself, bringing drop by drop the water of all the holy places, created 'Bindu-sarovara.' Knowing this lake to be dear to Śiva, Śrī Caitanya bathed in it and so glorified it especially."

The *Skanda Purāṇa* tells how Śiva obtained Ekāmra-kānana. A king named "Kāśīrāja" worshipped Śiva, pleased him, and went to war with Kṛṣṇa, and Śiva helped him. Kāśīrāja was killed, Śiva's *pāśupata* weapon proved useless, and Kṛṣṇa burned Kāśī. Then Śiva, understanding Kṛṣṇa's greatness, begged forgiveness for his offense and obtained Ekāmra-kānana near Śrī Nīlācala. Here the kings of the Keśarī dynasty founded their capital and ruled the land of Utkala for several centuries.

Bathing in the Bhārgī River at Kamalapura —

কমলপুরে আসি' ভার্গীনদী-স্নান কৈল ।
নিত্যানন্দ-হাতে প্রভু দণ্ড ধরিল ॥ ১৪১ ॥

kamalapure āsi' bhārgīnadī-snāna kaila
to Kamalapura coming bath in the river Bhārgī did
nityānanda-hāte prabhu daṇḍa dharila
in Nityānanda's hands the Lord staff placed

141 Coming to Kamalapura, the Lord bathed in the river Bhārgī, leaving His staff in Nityānanda's hands.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Bhārgī River is now known as the "Daṇḍabhāṅgā" River; it lies three *krośas* north of Purī.

*The Lord goes for *darśana* of Kapoteśvara, and Nitāi secretly breaks His staff —*

কপোতেশ্বর দেখিতে গেলা ভক্তগণ সঙ্গে ।
এথা নিত্যানন্দপ্রভু কৈল দণ্ড-ভঙ্গে ॥ ১৪২ ॥

kapoteśvara dekhite gelā bhakta-gaṇa saṅge
Kapoteśvara to see went devotees with
ethā nityānanda-prabhu kaila daṇḍa-bhaṅge
here Nityānanda Prabhu made staff-breaking

142 He went with the devotees to see Kapoteśvara, and meanwhile Nityānanda Prabhu broke the staff.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Kapoteśvara is near the Daṇḍabhāṅgā River.

Anubhāṣya.
Kapoteśvara — a Śiva-liṅga.

তিন খণ্ড করি' দণ্ড দিল ভাসাঞা ।
ভক্ত-সঙ্গে আইলা প্রভু মহেশ দেখিঞা ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

tina khaṇḍa kari' daṇḍa dila bhāsāñā
three pieces making staff gave floating
bhakta-saṅge āilā prabhu maheśa dekhiñā
with the devotees came the Lord Maheśa seeing

143 He broke the staff into three pieces and threw them into the river. Then the Lord returned with the devotees from seeing Maheśa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The staff. Mahāprabhu left the staff He had received on taking *sannyāsa* in the hands of Nityānanda Prabhu and went to Kapoteśvara. Nityānanda Prabhu broke the staff into three pieces and set it floating on the waters of the Bhārgī; that is why the Bhārgī came to be called "Daṇḍabhāṅgā" ("the broken staff"). To subdue body, speech and mind, *sannyāsīs* also carry the *tridaṇḍa*. Śaṅkarācārya's rule is to carry the *ekadaṇḍa*. Considering that Śrī Mahāprabhu had no need to carry such a staff, Nityānanda Prabhu broke it.

Anubhāṣya.

The staff. At Kāṭoyā Śrī Gaurasundara accepted *ekadaṇḍa-sannyāsa* in the Bhāratī *sampradāya*, which descends from Śaṅkara. Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu broke that *sannyāsa* staff into three pieces and threw it into the Bhārgī River (the present "Daṇḍabhāṅgā"). In the order of *sannyāsa*, the staff is to be kept in the stages of *kuṭīcaka* and *bahūdaka*, but in the stages of *haṁsa* and *paramahaṁsa* one is enjoined to give it up. Gaurahari is the Lord of the fourteen worlds, and, unlike other *sannyāsīs*, He has no need to display a lower stage (*adhikāra*). Knowing this, Nityānanda-svarūpa broke the staff and threw it away.

Seeing the temple at Purī, the Lord, pained by separation from Kṛṣṇa, dances, absorbed in ecstasy —

জগন্নাথের দেউল দেখি' আবিষ্ট হৈলা ।
দণ্ডবৎ করি প্রেমে নাচিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

jagannāthera deula dekhi' āviṣṭa hailā
of Jagannātha the temple seeing overwhelmed became
daṇḍavat kari preme nācite lāgilā
prostration making in love to dance began

144 When He saw the temple of Jagannātha, He was overwhelmed. He bowed down flat, and in love He began to dance.

Anubhāṣya.

Deula, temple — the present temple of Śrī Jagannātha, built by King Anaṅgabhīma. The hall of *upala-bhoga*, the *bhoga-vardhana* hall and the high outer courtyard had not yet been built at that time.

ভক্তগণ আবিষ্ট হঞা, সবে নাচে গায় ।
প্রেমাবেশে প্রভু-সঙ্গে রাজমার্গে যায় ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

bhakta-gaṇa āviṣṭa hañā, sabe nāce gāya
the devotees overwhelmed being all dance sing
premāveśe prabhu-saṅge rāja-mārge yāya
absorbed in love with the Lord on the royal road go

145 The devotees too were overwhelmed, and they all danced and sang; absorbed in love, they went along the royal road with the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Rāja-mārga (the royal road) — the road by which pilgrims going for *darśana* of Jagannātha travel from Bengal to Puruṣottama.

হাসে, কান্দে, নাচে প্রভু হুঙ্কার গর্জ্জন ।
তিন ক্রোশ পথ হৈল — সহস্র-যোজন ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

hāse, kānde, nāce prabhu huṅkāra garjana
laughs weeps dances the Lord roaring thundering
tina krośa patha haila — sahasra-yojana
three krośa road became a thousand yojanas

146 The Lord laughed, wept and danced, roaring and thundering. For Him the road of three *krośas* became a thousand *yojanas*.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Mahāprabhu saw the temple of Śrī Jagannātha from three *krośas* away, and in extreme separation the *sāttvika-vikāras* appeared in Him: He became utterly agitated and full of longing for *darśana* of Bhagavān. In intense separation (*vipralambha*) a moment seems an age, and the *gopīs* blame the Creator for His foolishness in giving the eyes lids. In the same way the three-*krośa* road seemed to Mahāprabhu a distant thousand *yojanas*.

Arrival at Āṭhāranālā —

চলিতে চলিতে প্রভু আইলা ‘আঠারনালা’ ।
তাঁহা আসি’ প্রভু কিছু বাহ্য প্রকাশিলা ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

calite calite prabhu āilā ‘āṭhāranālā’
walking walking the Lord came Āṭhāranālā
tāṁhā āsi’ prabhu kichu bāhya prakāśilā
there coming the Lord some outward awareness showed

147 Walking on and on, the Lord came to Āṭhāranālā, and there He regained some outward awareness.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āṭhāranālā is the name of the bridge by which one enters the city of Purī; it has eighteen arches.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the “Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.”

The Lord returns to outward consciousness and asks Nitāi for His staff —

নিত্যানন্দে কহে প্রভু, — দেহ মোর দণ্ড ।
নিত্যানন্দ বলে, — দণ্ড হৈল তিন খণ্ড ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

nityānande kahe prabhu, — deha mora daṇḍa
to Nityānanda says the Lord give My staff
nityānanda bale, — daṇḍa haila tina khaṇḍa
Nityānanda says staff became three pieces

148 The Lord said to Nityānanda, “Give Me My staff.” Nityānanda said, “Your staff has broken into three pieces.

Nitāi's cleverness: He reports that the staff is broken —

প্রেমাবেশে পড়িলা তুমি, তোমারে ধরিনু ।
তোমা-সহ তেরছে দণ্ড-উপরে পড়িনু ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

premāveśe paḍilā tumi, tomāre dharinu
absorbed in love fell You You I caught
tomā-saha terache daṇḍa-upare paḍinu
You with sideways staff upon I fell

149 Overwhelmed by love, You fell, and I caught You. Then I fell sideways with You onto the staff.

দুইজনার ভরে দণ্ড খণ্ড খণ্ড হৈল ।
সেই দণ্ড কাঁহা পড়িল, কিছু না জানিল ॥ ১৫০ ॥

dui-janāra bhare daṇḍa khaṇḍa khaṇḍa haila
of the two by the weight staff piece piece became
sei daṇḍa kāṁhā paḍila, kichu nā jānila
that staff where fell anything not I knew

150 Under the weight of the two of Us the staff broke into pieces. Where it fell, I do not know.[6]

Nitāi asks the Lord to punish Him for breaking the staff —

মোর অপরাধে তোমার দণ্ড হৈল খণ্ড ।
যে উচিত হয়, মোর কর তাহা দণ্ড ॥ ১৫১ ॥

mora aparādhe tomāra daṇḍa haila khaṇḍa
by My offence Your staff became broken
ye ucita haya, mora kara tāhā daṇḍa
what fitting is Me do that punishment

151 Your staff has been broken through My offence. Punish Me as You see fit.”

The Lord is grieved and slightly angry —

শুনি’ কিছু মহাপ্রভু দুঃখ প্রকাশিলা ।
ঈষৎ ক্রোধ করি’ কিছু কহিতে লাগিলা ॥ ১৫২ ॥

śuni' kichu mahāprabhu duḥkha prakāśilā
hearing somewhat Mahāprabhu sorrow showed
īṣat krodha kari' kichu kahite lāgilā
slight anger making something to say began

152 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu showed a little sorrow, and with slight anger He said:

Anubhāṣya.

Nityānanda Prabhu knew that the *ekadaṇḍa* proper to *vaidha-sannyāsa* (*sannyāsa* according to the rules) was of no use to Mahāprabhu, and so He freed the Lord from carrying the staff of *vaidha-sannyāsa*. But Mahāprabhu became angry with Him. He thought that if the staff were given up in this way, the Vedic rules would grow lax before the unqualified *daṇḍīs* who take *vivitsā-sannyāsa* (*sannyāsa* out of the desire for knowledge) became qualified. All other people in the world follow the conduct of the great. Some with deluded minds neglect the path of rules favorable to devotion taught in the Śrutis, Smṛtis, Purāṇas and other scriptures; not understanding its purpose, they take a disorderly path for the path of *anurāga* or for the conduct of an *avadhūta*. Such people would be harmed — and so the Lord enacted this pastime of showing anger.

The Lord's reproach —

নীলাচলে আসি' মোর সবে হিত কৈলা ।
সবে দণ্ডধন ছিল, তাহা না রাখিলা ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

nīlācale āsi' mora sabe hita kailā
to Nīlācala coming My all good did
sabe daṇḍa-dhana chila, tāhā nā rākhilā
only the wealth of a staff was that not kept

153 "You have all done Me a fine service on the way to Nīlācala! My only wealth was My staff, and you did not even keep that safe.

*The Lord expresses His wish to go alone for *darśana* of Jagannātha —*

তুমি-সব আগে যাহ ঈশ্বর দেখিতে ।
কিবা আমি আগে যাই, না যাব সহিতে ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

tumi-saba āge yāha īśvara dekhite
you all ahead go the Lord to see
kibā āmi āge yāi, nā yāba sahite
or I ahead go not shall go together

154 Either all of you go ahead to see the Lord, or I go ahead; I will not go together with you."

At Mukunda's word the Lord goes to Purī alone, ahead of everyone —

মুকুন্দ দত্ত কহে, — প্রভু, তুমি যাহ আগে ।
আমি-সব পাছে যাব, না যাব তোমার সঙ্গে ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

mukunda datta kahe, — prabhu, tumi yāha āge
Mukunda Datta says Lord You go ahead
āmi-saba pāche yāba, nā yāba tomāra saṅge
we all behind shall go not shall go You with

155 Mukunda Datta said, "Lord, You go ahead. We shall all follow behind; we shall not go with You."

The moods of the two Prabhus are inconceivable —

এত শুনি' প্রভু আগে চলিলা শীঘ্রগতি ।
বুঝিতে না পারে কেহ দুই প্রভুর মতি ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

eta śuni' prabhu āge calilā śīghra-gati
thus hearing the Lord ahead went with swift steps
bujhite nā pāre keha dui prabhura mati
to understand not can anyone of the two Lords the minds

156 Hearing this, the Lord went on ahead with swift steps. No one can understand the minds of the two Lords.

ইঁহো কেনে দণ্ড ভাঙ্গে, তেঁহো কেনে ভাঙ্গায় ।
ভাঙ্গাঞা ক্রোধে তেঁহো ইঁহাকে দোষায় ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

iṁho kene daṇḍa bhāṅge, teṁho kene bhāṅgāya
this One why staff breaks that One why lets break
bhāṅgāñā krodhe teṁho iṁhāke doṣāya
having let break in anger that One this One blames

157 Why does one of Them break the staff, and why does the Other let Him? And having let Him break it, why does the Other then blame Him in anger?

Only a devotee who sees the Two as nondifferent can understand this pastime

—

দণ্ডভঙ্গ-লীলা এই — পরম গম্ভীর ।
সেই বুঝে, দুঁহার পদে যাঁর ভক্তি ধীর ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

daṇḍa-bhaṅga-līlā ei — parama gambhīra
the staff-breaking pastime this supremely profound
sei bujhe, duṁhāra pade yāṁra bhakti dhīra
he understands of both at the feet whose devotion steady

158 This pastime of the breaking of the staff is profound indeed. Only one whose devotion to the feet of both is steadfast can understand it.

Anubhāṣya.

Only those who have truly understood Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, steadily and calmly, will grasp the true nature of the two Prabhus and the meaning of the pastime of breaking the staff. The great souls of the past accepted the staff through service to Kṛṣṇa's feet and gave up absorption in worldly existence. Mahāprabhu too accepts that a *sādhaka* following the path of the great souls needs *vaidha-sannyāsa*. In *vidvat-sannyāsa* (the *sannyāsa* of those who know) the staff is not needed. But *vivitsā-sannyāsa* — a practice favorable to devotion, a gradual path of renouncing worldly things — is needed in the life of a *sādhaka* in order to teach people: this is Mahāprabhu's intention. Nityānanda, His servant, knew that carrying the staff, with which Prabhu Gauracandra's *sannyāsa* began, is in fact unnecessary at the high stage of the *paramahaṁsa*. So that other people of material mind would not commit offense by wrongly thinking that Śrī Mahāprabhu stood at the stage of *kuṭīcaka* or *bahūdaka*, Nityānanda made Him give up the staff and so showed the example of the very highest stage.

Since the speaker and the hearer are both Bhagavān, the story of Sākṣi-gopāla is beyond this world —

ব্রহ্মণ্যদেব-গোপালের মহিমা এই ধন্য ।
নিত্যানন্দ — বক্তা যার, শ্রোতা — শ্রীচৈতন্য ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

brahmaṇya-deva-gopālera mahimā ei dhanya
of Gopāla, the Lord of the brāhmaṇas glory this blessed
nityānanda — vaktā yāra, śrotā — śrī caitanya
Nityānanda narrator of which listener Śrī Caitanya

159 Blessed is this glory of Gopāla, the Lord of the brāhmaṇas: Nityānanda was its narrator, and Śrī Caitanya its listener.

Anubhāṣya.

(1) The form of Śrī Gopāla is the eternally true *vigraha*. (2) He is Truth Himself embodied: transcending the worldly laws of matter, He always upholds the honor of truth. (3) In a brāhmaṇa's life it is especially necessary to abide in truth. (4) Kṛṣṇa Himself both establishes brahminhood (*brahmaṇya*) and submits to it; therefore brahminhood that takes shelter of Kṛṣṇa is not merely a thing of *māyā*.

The faithful hearer attains the feet of Śrī Kṛṣṇa —

শ্রদ্ধাযুক্ত হঞা ইহা শুনে যেই জন ।
অচিরে মিলয়ে তারে গোপাল-চরণ ॥ ১৬০ ॥

śraddhā-yukta hañā ihā śune yei jana
with faith endowed being this hears which person
acire milaye tāre gopāla-caraṇa
soon attains him Gopāla's feet

160 Whoever hears this with faith will very soon attain the feet of Gopāla.

Anubhāṣya.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যার আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ১৬১ ॥

śrī rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

161 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 4.2; translation as there. ↩
2. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads যাজপুরে সে রাত্রি রহি' করিলা গমন ("staying that night in Yājapura, He went on"); another reading is …করিলা যাপন ("He spent that night in Yājapura"). ↩
3. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads ইথে কি বিস্ময় ("what is surprising in that?"); another reading is করিল নিশ্চয় ("I have firmly decided"). ↩
4. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads কি তোমার ব্যবহার ("what conduct is this of yours?"); another reading is কি তোমার বিচার ("what is your decision?"). ↩
5. The Bengali text follows the edition (p. 377, checked under magnification): সাক্ষির আগমন (previously আগমনে), rhyming with ভবন. ↩
6. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads সেই দণ্ড কাঁহা পড়িল ("where that staff fell"); another reading is সেই খণ্ড ("those pieces"). ↩
7. So in the *Anubhāṣya*: *adbhutehaṁ* is one word, qualifying Sākṣi-gopāla ("of unprecedented deeds"); the transliteration of the verse divides it as *'dbhute 'haṁ*. ↩
8. The second verse is *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.52.25; the edition gives both verses under the single reference 10.52.21. ↩
9. So in the edition: the gloss begins with the word *rāja*, while verse 122 reads *rājya* (*cala mora rājya*, "come to my kingdom"); the gloss explains that the word here means "to the kingdom." ↩